

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7
♥ 10 7 6 4 2
♦ A 6 4 3
♣ 7

♠ A J 5
♥ K Q
♦ Q J 8
♣ 10 9 8 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 4 2
♥ 9 8 5
♦ 10 9 7
♣ A 4

♠ 6 3
♥ A J 3
♦ K 5 2
♣ K Q J 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1♣	1♠	3♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠K			

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, West played the ♠7 and North the ♠5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠6, ♠5, ♠4, ♠3 and ♠2. So the ♠7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

North held up with ♠A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦10 West will win the ♦A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠A while you still have the ♣A for an entry.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2



♠ J 7 5

♥ 10 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A 9 8

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

1 ♣

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ K

to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate South for the fine play.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ K, East played the ♠ 7 and South the ♠ 8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠ 4.

You cannot see the ♠ 5. The most likely reason is that East has it, and his ♠ 7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠ A or ♠ J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠ s to drive out South's ♠ A. When you get the lead with your ♣ A you will cash your ♠ winners and East will still have the ♦ A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if South is a better than average Declarer. East just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving South ♠ A J 8 5. South played the ♠ 8 as a falsecard

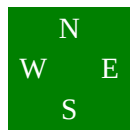
Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6 3
♥ Q 10
♦ 10 9 5 4 2
♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9
♥ A 9 7 5 2
♦ A K
♣ 10 9 7



♠ 5 4
♥ 6 4
♦ J 7 3
♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K J 8 3
♦ Q 8 6
♣ J 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	2 ♣	3 ♣
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♣ A			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.
Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 4

Play the ♣ 8 to encourage a continuation. East will
play the ♣ Q on which you will play the ♣ 2.

East now knows you started with a doubleton, and
more importantly, he also knows you want him to
play a third ♣.

When he next plays the ♣ K dummy will ruff, but
whatever card he ruffs with you will have established
a trump trick. When you later win your ♠ K that will
be down 1.

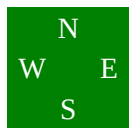
Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3
 ♥ J 8 4 3
 ♦ K J 9 5 2
 ♣ 8 2

♠ J 8 4
 ♥ 7 6 2
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ K J 9 6 5



♠ Q 10 9 6 2
 ♥ 10 9
 ♦ Q 7 3
 ♣ A 7 4

♠ A K 5
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ A 10 6
 ♣ Q 10 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦5			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, East wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. South holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that East holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If East is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it South's chance of making 9 tricks.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

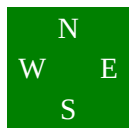
♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

2 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 2

Play the ♣ 3.

If you signal with the ♣ 9 East will continue with the ♣ K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣ J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦ K, return the ♣ 9 back to East's ♣ K, and still have your trump trick for later.